Nile Brew Co. - Employee Handbook

Nile Brew Co. is a specialty coffee roastery founded in 2018 in Alexandria, Egypt by Karim Hassan and Salma Fathy. The company roasts beans sourced from Ethiopia, Colombia and Brazil and sells them through its own cafes and an online store. As of 2026 the company employs 42 people across three branches: Alexandria, Cairo (Maadi) and Sheikh Zayed.

This handbook explains how we work, what benefits employees receive, and how to handle common situations. Please read every section carefully during your first week.

1. Working Hours and Attendance

Cafe staff work in two shifts: the morning shift runs from 7:00 AM to 3:00 PM and the evening shift runs from 3:00 PM to 11:00 PM. Office staff work from 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM, Sunday to Thursday. Friday and Saturday are the weekend for office staff.

Employees must clock in using the Nile Brew mobile app. Arriving more than 15 minutes late three times in one month results in a written warning. Employees who need to change a shift must request it at least 48 hours in advance through their branch manager.

2. Leave Policy

Every full-time employee receives 21 days of paid annual leave per year. After five years of service this increases to 30 days. Annual leave must be requested at least two weeks in advance, except in emergencies.

Sick leave is 10 days per year and requires a medical certificate if it exceeds two consecutive days. Unused annual leave can be carried over to the next year, but only up to a maximum of 7 days. Any days beyond that are lost.

New mothers receive 90 days of paid maternity leave. Fathers receive 5 days of paid paternity leave.

3. Salary, Bonuses and Benefits

Salaries are paid on the 25th of every month by bank transfer. If the 25th falls on a Friday or Saturday, payment is made on the preceding Thursday.

Employees who complete one full year receive an annual bonus equal to one month of base salary, paid in December. The Barista of the Year award comes with an additional cash prize of 15,000 EGP and a trip to the Specialty Coffee Expo.

All employees receive health insurance through Delta Care, covering the employee and up to two dependents. Staff also get a 40 percent discount on all products and one free bag of coffee (250 grams) every month.

4. Coffee Quality Standards

Every batch of beans is roasted in a 15 kg Probat roaster. Light roasts are roasted for about 9 minutes, and dark roasts for about 14 minutes. Roasted coffee must be sold within 30 days of the roast date. After 30 days, any remaining stock is donated to local charities or used for staff training.

Espresso must be extracted at a water temperature of 93 degrees Celsius for 25 to 30 seconds, using 18 grams of ground coffee to produce 36 grams of espresso. Baristas must taste-test the first shot of each day and record the result in the quality log.

Milk must be steamed to between 60 and 65 degrees Celsius. Milk steamed above 70 degrees must be discarded.

5. Customer Service and Complaints

Greet every customer within 10 seconds of entering the cafe. If a drink is made incorrectly, the barista must remake it free of charge without argument.

For serious complaints, such as a customer feeling unwell, the staff member must immediately inform the branch manager, who must fill in an incident report within 24 hours. Online orders can be refunded within 14 days of delivery if the bag is unopened.

Customer feedback is reviewed every Monday at 10:00 AM in a meeting led by the Head of Operations, Mona Ibrahim.

6. Training and Career Growth

New baristas complete a 4-week training program. Week 1 covers hygiene and safety, week 2 covers espresso, week 3 covers milk and latte art, and week 4 covers customer service and the point-of-sale system. After passing a final practical exam, the barista receives a certificate.

Employees may apply for the Roastmaster track after 18 months of service. Selected employees receive a company-paid course at the Coffee Academy in Cairo, worth up to 25,000 EGP.

For questions about this handbook, contact HR at hr@nilebrew.example or speak to your branch manager.